Who Is Artificial Intelligence?

FROM TECHNOLOGICAL SYSTEMS TO INSTITUTIONAL ACTORS

A new framework for understanding AI's role in the modern economy

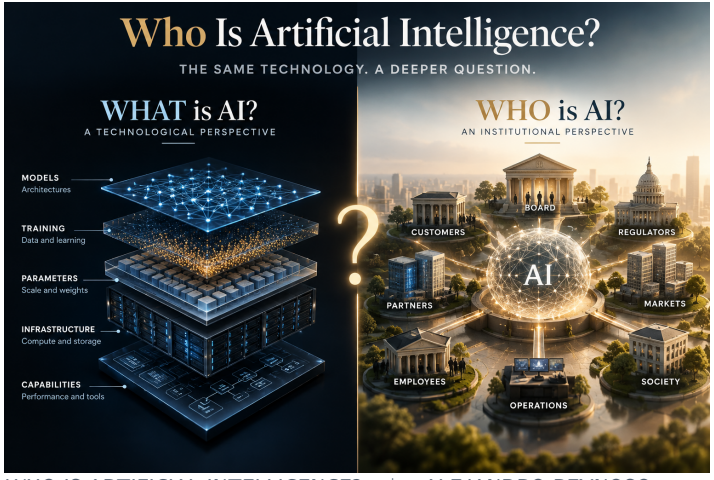


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The Question That Changes Everything

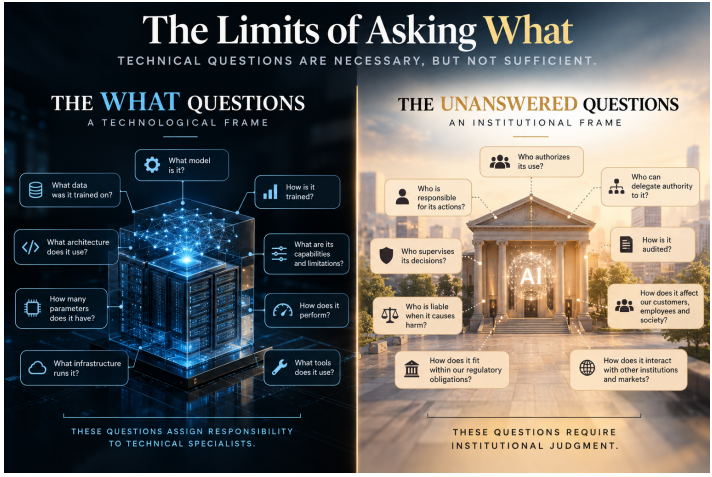
From technological description to institutional identity



- A change of one word transforms the framework.
- What explains how AI works; who reveals its institutional role.
- The question concerns relationships, not personhood.

The Limits of Asking What

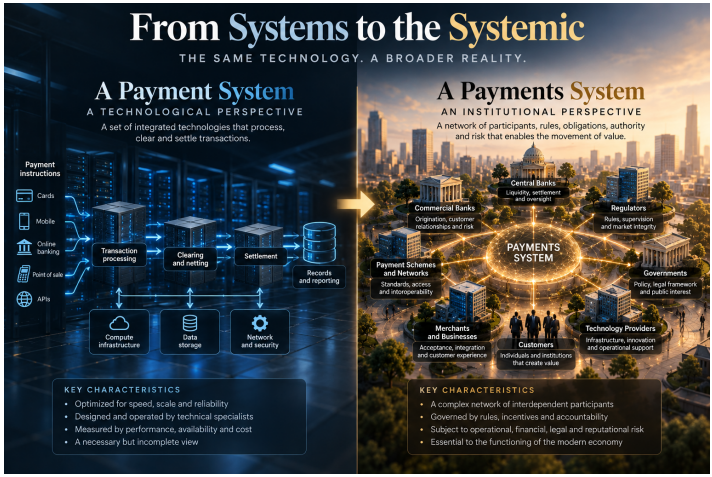
Necessary technical knowledge is not sufficient



- Models, data and infrastructure describe the technology.
- A technical framing naturally delegates the discussion to specialists.
- Authority, accountability and institutional consequences remain unanswered.

From Systems to the Systemic

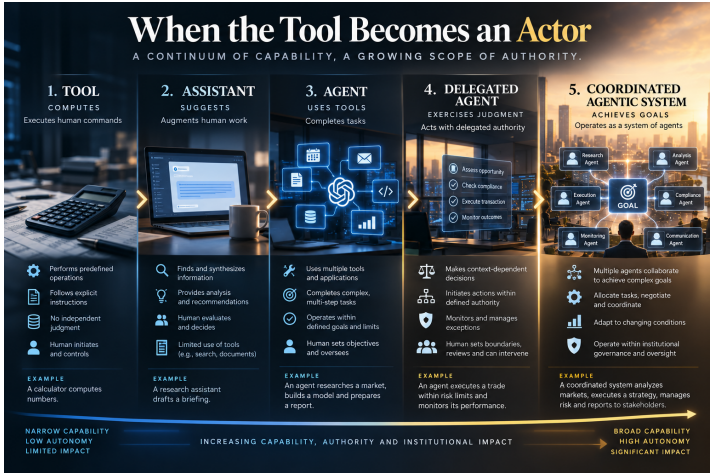
A lesson from financial infrastructure



- A payment system processes and settles transactions.
- The payments system connects institutions, obligations and risks.
- Understanding AI requires studying the surrounding institutional network.

When the Tool Becomes an Actor

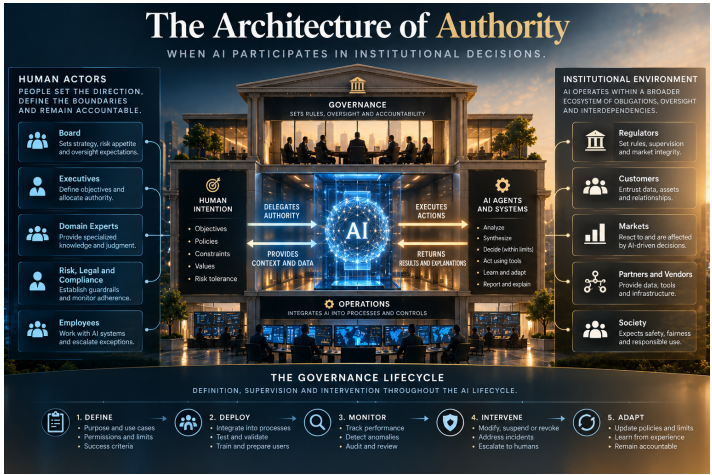
From assistance to delegated action



- Tools execute instructions; assistants provide recommendations.
- Agents use tools, pursue goals and coordinate complex tasks.
- Greater capability requires explicitly bounded authority and oversight.

The Architecture of Authority

Governance is an institutional design problem



- Define decision rights, permissions and escalation routes.
- Preserve human supervision, auditability and intervention.
- Assign responsibility for outcomes before delegating action.

A New Literacy for Leadership

Technology and institutional judgment are complementary



- Executives need to understand capabilities and limitations.
- Finance offers expertise in agency, incentives and systemic risk.
- Leadership integrates technical knowledge with institutional responsibility.

The Question for the Board

Who is our artificial intelligence?



- What role and authority have we given AI?
- Who supervises, challenges and can stop its actions?
- Who ultimately stands accountable for the consequences?